SYSTEM NAME	**COMMUNICATION & CONSULTATION** PROCEDURE
SYSTEM NUMBER	RNSWP005
PURPOSE & SCOPE	The purpose & scope of this procedure is to provide guidelines and instructions for communicating the effectiveness of the WHS System, including environmental and health and safety requirements, objectives, policies, and achievements as well as product and process performance information.
CONNECTING DOCUMENTS	RNSWF011 Consultation Statement RNSWF012 Toolbox Talk Record

TASK	STEPS	FREQUENCY	POSITION
CONSULTATION ARRANGEMENTS			
Create WHS Notice Board	Establish at each site a dedicated WHS Notice Board, placed in an accessible location.	As Required	HSEQ Team
Establish Work Groups	*Work Groups* shall be established within 14 days when requested by workers through negotiations and an agreement with workers. These negotiations shall be instigated to determine: • the number and structure of Work Groups to be represented by Health & Safety Representatives (HSRs); • the number of HSRs and Deputy HSRs (if any) to be elected in each Work Group • the workplace(s) (i.e. projects sites, depots etc..) to which the Work Groups will apply; and • specifically, the businesses or undertakings (incl. any contractors) to which the *Work Groups* will apply Relevant workers shall be notified of the outcome of the negotiations and of any *Work Groups* determined by agreement. Minutes of negotiations and outcomes relating to *Work Group* discussions shall be recorded, the structure of *Work Groups* shall be communicated to *Personnel*. *Work Group* structures shall also be displayed on the WHS Notice Board(s). All workers within defined *Work Groups* are eligible to be elected as a HSR unless disqualified.	As Required	General Managers/ Responsible Managers

TASK	STEPS	FREQUENCY	POSITION
Nomination & Election of HSRs	Nominate and elect *HSRs and Deputy HSRs (where applicable)* for each *Work Group* as determined through negotiation and agreement. The outcomes of the *HSR* elections shall be minute and the names of HSR's shall be communicated to personnel and displayed on WHS Notice Board(s). Communicate with the WHS Manager if you need to complete this process.	-	*Work Group* members
HSR Terms of Office	The Terms of office for HSRs shall be for a maximum tenure of 3 years unless the HSR has resigned, is no longer a worker in the *Work Group*, disqualified, or removed from the position by a majority of workers of the *Work Group*.	-	Responsible Managers
Training for HSRs	Elected HSR's must attend a training program accredited by the relevant state WHS Authority as soon as practicable within 3 months after a request to attend training has been made. Training provided shall: • be approved by the regulator, and • chosen by the HSR in consultation with management. Training shall be undertaken before HSRs can exercises certain powers.	-	
Establishing Consultation Arrangements	To establish the site-specific consultation arrangements, all site employees, including contractors, shall have an opportunity to understand the available consultation options for matters relating to health and safety. This is discussed at annually and documented on a toolbox talk form. Workers attending site after this initial meeting are introduced to this via the WHS Induction. The selected consultation arrangement is documented in the **RNSWF011 Consultation Statement** and displayed on the site notice WHS Board. Where other agreed arrangements are selected and a WHS Manager/s is selected, they are required to have the training as set out in **Section 1 – Competence**.	As Required	HSEQ Team
Management of Workplace Change	Actions arising from discussions relating to changes shall be recorded, monitored and closed out in a timely manner. Appropriate consultation with personnel shall occur and includes (but limited to) proposed changes to	-	Responsible Managers

TASK	STEPS	FREQUENCY	POSITION
	the work environment, processes or practices, proposed corrective actions and purchasing decisions that could affect their health and safety.		
Senior Management Site Visits	Senior management will visit sites to discuss WHS issues, participate in discussions or promote initiatives. Senior Management will ensure that organisational wide WHS initiatives are captured and discussed with site management and employees.	At least annually	Senior Management
Conduct Toolbox Meetings	Toolbox meetings shall be conducted at least weekly with or without a manager present. These meetings can be conducted via a variety of means including assembling together as a team, via phone hook-up, video conference or any other communication method. All Toolbox meetings shall be documented, and actions recorded, and the **RNSWF012 Toolbox Talk Record** shall be used for the document. Actions arising from Toolbox meetings shall be managed via **RNSWP16 NCR Management.**	As Required	Manager
Development of Policy and Procedures	All employees shall be consulted in the development of policy, procedures and processes, including Work Instructions and Safe Work Method Statements (SWMS). These will be brought up at the weekly toolbox talks and communicated with the team.	-	HSEQ Manager
Provision of information in LOTE	WHS information where required shall be provided to personnel in *Languages other than English* (LOTE). Please contact the WHS Manager if this is required.	-	
Raise issues and report issue resolutions, escalations, or outcomes	The Issue Resolution process shall be communicated to all Personnel, including mandatory discussion of the process during employee induction. All Health and Safety issues are to be reported as soon as practicable to the area manager. They will document and investigate all hazards reported immediately; the investigation findings will be detailed and reported back to the workgroup at the next opportunity (normally pre shift meeting). Should the person\s reporting the safety issue believe the matter remains unresolved or not adequately addressed, the worker can raise the matter with the WHS Manager. The WHS Manager will review the identified hazards, completed documents and actions by the Site Supervisor and provide feedback accordingly to either party, confirming either the measures implemented are	-	Responsible Manager

TASK	STEPS	FREQUENCY	POSITION
	satisfactory OR requiring the Site Supervisor to undertake further actions to address the matter raised. The report compiled by the WHS Manager and outcomes will be provided to the Project Manager. The person\s reporting the safety issue can further escalate the matter directly with the Project Manager, WHS Manager and \ or Company Director\s should they believe the actions taken do not satisfactorily resolve the risks identified. Should they exhaust all possible internal avenues, the person\s may contact SafeWork QLD for assistance. Public and third-party complaints must be recorded as incidences and actioned via the **RNSWP16 NCR Management**.		

EXTERNAL COMMUNICATION			
Communicate with Interested Parties - publicly available information	Akron shall also provide to Clients/Customers and other Interested Parties with publicly available information including: • Health & Safety Policy • Environmental Policy • Quality Policy • General brochures and information sheets • Safety Data Sheets (SDS) All other requests for information shall be reviewed and, if appropriate, authorised by the HSEQ Team or Management. For the avoidance of doubt, Information requiring review and authorisation includes, but is not limited to: • Policies / Procedures • Objectives and Targets • Project / Site Management Plans • Emergency Response Plans • Incident Reports • Manufacturing process and materials used • Site storage facilities • Transport arrangements to and from the site WHS Information that is confidential, commercially sensitive or under legal privilege shall not be uploaded into the **Smartsheet** unless authorised by the HSEQ Team.		Responsible Managers HSEQ Manager
General enquiries from the public or community	Contact initiated by the community occurs for many reasons and may be in person, via telephone, fax, email, or letter. The way it is dealt with is dependent on the issue being raised. If the contact is in relation to a complaint, the employee or subcontractor who receives the initial contact must complete the **NCR Form**. The Responsible Manager will determine what action is required and document the actions taken. Any questions regarding the nature of the works must be recorded and provided to the Responsible Manager for follow up.	-	All Workers
Communicate with Regulatory Authorities	If a phone call from an external authority (not in the capacity as a client) is received by a site, the call is to be attended to by the HSEQ Team or Management. They must ensure that a record of the phone call is documented and the appropriate action is taken to address the correspondence.	-	All Workers

Communicate with Media	The Management team is the official spokesperson of the Company and has appointed other Authorised Spokespersons to represent the Company. Only Authorised Spokespersons may communicate with the media on behalf of the Company. Unless an employee has been appointed an Authorised Spokesperson, he or she must not speak to or deal with the media on behalf of the Company.	-	General Manager

RECORDS MANAGEMENT				
NAME	**FILE LOCATION**	**RETENTION PERIOD**	**DISPOSAL METHOD**	**RESPONSIBLE**
Consultation Statements	Smartsheet	15 years	Delete	HSEQ Manager
Toolbox Talks	Smartsheet	7 years	Delete	HSEQ Manager
Other Meeting Minutes	Smartsheet	7 years	Delete	HSEQ Manager